

world sit up and take notice of the Nexus line as something they should be interested in, even if they weren't developers. And boy did the Nexus 4 deliver! It was launched on November 13, 2012. Google partnered up with LG this time around. It was easily the handsomest Nexus device, a slim bar of unblemished black glass on the front with a silver metal framing it and a truly gorgeous glass back with a speckled circles pattern. It had a 1280*768 px screen with a pixel density of 318 ppi. The Nexus 4 was the first phone to integrate the touch digitizer and IPS panel together, allowing for an illusion of actually touching the apps. On the inside, the Nexus 4 had a Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 Pro SoC with 2 gigs of Ram and a dual core Krait processor with either 8 or 16 gigs of storage.

And the best part was, these impressive specifications actually came cheap! Starting at \$299 unlocked from the Google Play Store (\$100 cheaper than other stores, leading to claims of Google subsidizing the sales of the Nexus 4), it appealed to a huge demographic of people wanting powerful Android smartphones but unwilling to pay the price for a flagship. The Nexus 4 came out with Android 4.2 Jellybean, "a sweeter version of Jellybean" as Google branded it, which brought minor updates to polish up the already decent original. The Nexus 4 received rave reviews and was a runaway hit, being sold out almost all the time for a week when it first launched and had pretty much no negatives to speak of, except for the notable absence of LTE. Still, the Nexus 4 can be called the phone that brought the Nexus line into the limelight and set the bar for all future Nexus releases.

• Nexus 5

Just like with Samsung, Google decided to go again with the same OEM partner after a hit. The Nexus 5 was released on Halloween, 2013, amidst high expectations that only putting out successful phones for 3 years together can evoke. The Nexus 5 made the switch to futuristic polycarbonate after the glass from the Nexus 4 (perhaps because the decorative glass back on the 4 shattered too easily). It was a nicely designed phone, with discreet Nexus branding on the back and was very aesthetically pleasing. It had a Qualcomm Snapdragon 800 SoC with a Krait 400 CPU and 2 gigs of RAM. It was available in 16 and 32 gig variants. While the internals were awe worthy, the screen was the biggest let down. Even though the 4.95 inch screen was FHD 1920*1080 resolution with an IPS panel and whopping 445 pi, it wasn't particularly bright, especially compared to the competitors. Added to the fact that to hit the \$349 price point, Google decided to make